

Besmelh Alshaalan

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CAREER SYNOPSIS

- Strong background in human-centered research, experience & service design, usability testing, and product prototyping (web, mobile, XR, physical products), with strategic thinking applied across digital and physical products.
- Skilled in graphics, VR, and game development using Unity, Unreal Engine, and WebGPU, with additional experience in React.
- Experienced with full-stack development, AI/ML, and cloud-native systems through coursework and internships.
- Proven leadership across global teams and internships; adaptable to fast-paced, interdisciplinary environments.

EDUCATION

KAUST (King Abdullah University for Science and Technology)

Master's in Computer Science; GPA: 3.53/4.0

Thuwal, KSA

Aug 2023 - Jan 2025

University of Rochester

Rochester, NY, USA

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science | Minor in Digital Media Studies; GPA: 3.53/4.0

Aug 2019 - May 2023

Certifications: Google Cloud Associate Cloud Engineer — Google Cloud, 2025

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cloud Software and Platform Engineer Associate, Accenture, Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

July 2025 – Oct 2025

- Gained hands-on experience in GCP (Google Cloud Platform) and consulting through intensive training and client-aligned projects.
- Led user research, ideation, and prototyping of a youth-first travel experience, winning 1st place at Accenture's Innovation Hub challenge.
- Developed an educational system with gesture-based math games and a progress dashboard, showcased at LEARN 2025 conference.

VR Game Development Intern, Saudi Aramco, Dhahran, Saudi Arabia

June 2024 – Aug 2024

- Researched and prototyped an educational oil exploration game using Figma, completing ~30% of game development process.
- Developed VR project template with hand tracking to convert existing Oculus projects to Vive Focus 3 projects, in Unreal Engine.

Research Intern, Nano-visualization Research Group, KAUST, Thuwal, Saudi Arabia

Jan 2024 – May 2024

- Converting functionality of an existing OpenGL application to WebGPU, for automated camera animations in a molecular biology visualization system, enhancing documentary-style video creation; through navigated and contributed to complex GitHub project.

Teaching Assistant, University of Rochester

Aug 2021 – May 2023

- Video Game Development class (Spring 2023), supported students as they develop games in Unreal Engine.
- iOS Mobile App Development class (Fall 2021), helped students as they developed iOS apps in Swift.

Media Tech Intern, NBCUniversal, Los Angeles, CA

June 2022 – Aug 2022

- Created applications to automate intern alumni browsing and business verification, enhancing efficiency.
- Migrated and optimized an Excel sheet to Airtable for better data maintainability and analytics generation.

Tech and Product Intern, Millie Group, New York, NY

May 2021 – Aug 2021

- Conducted user research, designed UI/UX in Figma, and applied service design principles to finalize features of an internal platform.
- Developed a PERN Stack (PostgreSQL, Express, React, NodeJS) app, and managed the database through PostgreSQL & AWS.

IBM Accelerate Software Apprenticeship, IBM, Virtual, USA

May 2021 – July 2021

- Completed intensive software apprenticeship, building full-stack apps while strengthening Agile collaboration and debugging skills.

PROJECTS

Phobigone

Aug 2022 - Dec 2022

- Designed and developed a VR game in Unity to help users overcome phobias using 3D cityscapes, and conducted usability testing.

BalanceBuddy

Jan 2022 - May 2022

- Conducted user research, Figma design, and built a React + MongoDB web app with Chrome extension for student task tracking.

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

ShenTech Entrepreneurship Bootcamp, InnoX Academy, Shenzhen, China.

Jan 2024

- Recognized as a top project; a shoe-cleaning device, designed by conducting user research, prototyping, and market analysis.

Student Volunteer, SIGGRAPH Asia 2022, Daegu, South Korea

Dec 2022

- Supported the conference's events like the Computer Animation Festival & Emerging Technologies exhibition.

Marketing & Design Team Lead, DandyHacks Hackathon 2022, Rochester, USA

Mar 2022 – Nov 2022

- Led a team of 4, and increased participation by 60% and project submissions by 277% via strategic design and growth planning.

SKILLS

- **Research & Strategy:** Human-centered research, experience & service design, usability testing, strategy thinking, UI/UX design
- **Programming:** Python, C, C++, C#, Java, JavaScript, Swift, SQL, Bash, Git, React, WebGPU, Numpy, SciPy, sklearn, PyTorch, GCP
- **Design:** Figma, Blender, Unreal Engine, Unity, Adobe CC (Illustrator, Photoshop, Premiere Pro)
- **Soft Skills & Languages:** Adaptability, creativity, problem-solving, leadership; Arabic (Native), English (Fluent)